

ORGANIC PERFORMANCE · WHAT THE CAMERA BEATS THE TEMPLATE AT

Real photos out-earn made graphics, four to one.

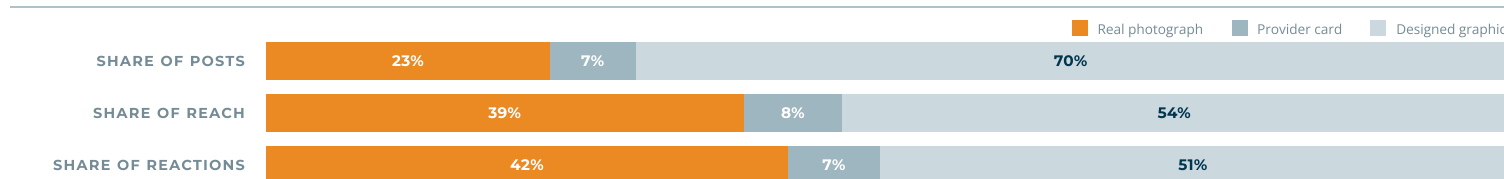
Every Facebook and Instagram post from March 18 to August 31 was pulled apart and its creative hand-classified, with all boosted reach and boosted reactions stripped out. Posts built from **real photographs of staff, patients and events** earn **3.8 times** the median organic reactions of designed graphics, and reach more people besides. They are **23% of what gets posted**.

PHOTO VS GRAPHIC 3.8× Median organic reactions, 15 vs 4	REAL PHOTOS ARE ONLY 23% Of everything published
GRAPHICS BOOSTED 64% vs 35% of real photos	ORGANIC REACH 144.6K 188 posts, Mar 18 – Aug 31

Creative scorecard Organic only. Meta's reported "from ads" reach and reactions are subtracted from every post; 188 posts classified by eye.

CREATIVE TYPE	POSTS	% OF OUTPUT	MEDIAN REACH	MEDIAN REACTIONS	ENG. RATE	SHARES / POST
Real photograph Staff, patients, events, facilities	43	22.9%	511	 15	1.81%	1.35
Provider card Real headshot in a branded template	13	6.9%	499	 6	1.56%	0.85
Designed graphic Text, layout, stock, event flyers	132	70.2%	393	 4	1.42%	2.31

Effort against return Real photographs take up a quarter of the calendar and bring back two fifths of the engagement. Designed graphics do the reverse.



Top organic posts Ad reach removed

POST	REACH	REACT.	TYPE
Mill City, Idanha and Detroit service update May 28 · Facebook	7,376	135	GRAPHIC
Coffee Corner hours expanded Jun 29 · Facebook	12,566	113	PHOTO
When seconds count, you shouldn't have to drive Jul 29 · Facebook	5,536	89	PHOTO
Another year in the books, 37th Annual Jun 10 · Facebook + Instagram	2,892	75	GRAPHIC
A fantastic day at the Aumsville Corn Festival Aug 17 · Instagram	2,851	54	PHOTO
Proud to celebrate with the community Jul 6 · Facebook + Instagram	3,450	53	PHOTO

What this means

- The staff are the content.** A real photograph of people at work is the single most reliable organic performer you have, at 15 median reactions against 4.
- You are rationing your best format.** Real photos are 23% of output. Moving them to half would lift organic engagement without a dollar of spend.
- Graphics do earn their shares.** 2.31 shares per post against 1.35 for photos. Event and announcement creative is built to be forwarded, and that is a real job worth keeping.
- Provider cards sit in between.** A real face in a branded frame lands at 6 median reactions: better than a graphic, well short of a candid.

Channel ledger Full period, paid included

CHANNEL	VIEWS	INTERACTIONS	ENG.
Facebook Santiam Hospital & Clinics	3,868,116	12,655	0.33%
Instagram santiamhospitalandclinics	283,870	2,962	1.04%
Facebook Family Birth Center	149,562	4,875	3.26%
LinkedIn 100% organic, zero paid	28,333	428	1.51%
X (Twitter) 40-post sample	470	3	0.64%

What we're changing

- Shift the mix toward the camera.** Target roughly half of posts as real photography, drawn from rounds, new hires, procedures, community events.
- Redirect the boost budget.** 64% of graphics get money behind them against 35% of photos. The spend is propping up the weaker format.
- Keep graphics for what they do best:** dates, registration, awareness months, anything where the share is the call to action.
- Build a capture habit.** The constraint is supply, not appetite: someone needs a phone in hand on rounds and at every community event.

Method. Facebook and Instagram post data from Meta Business Suite → Insights → Content, Stories excluded. Each post's creative thumbnail was viewed and hand-sorted into real photograph, provider portrait card, or designed graphic; that classification is our judgement, not a Meta field. All post figures are organic; Meta reports a "from ads" portion for reach and reactions on boosted posts and that portion is subtracted. Channel ledger figures cover the full period and include paid. Pulled September 10, 2026.

Why the creative window starts March 18. Meta's Content table stops serving rows at roughly 200; 193 posts were retrievable in one pass, reaching back to March 18. The comparison rests on **188 posts with reach across 5.5 months**, which is ample, but it is not the full eight.